

Leave Policy

Purpose

The purpose of the policy is to cater the need of team members' welfare by providing them opportunity to avail authorised leaves as a benefit while working at Cogent Labs. The guidelines outlined in the policy will facilitate in establishing and regulating leave entitlement to support a positive work life balance of team members at Cogent Labs.

Scope/Eligibility

This policy has been designed for the team members of Cogent Labs keeping in view their functional requirements. All team members who are working in Cogent Labs in whatsoever capacity, come under the scope of the policy.

Policy and Procedures

Application process

- Leave requests are submitted **through Keep Kaam**. Employees no longer need to email their team lead or CC HR, **the request is routed automatically to the team lead for approval**.
- Once the **team lead approves** the request on Keep Kaam, **HR is notified automatically**, and the status is reflected on the employee's **Keep Kaam dashboard**.
- If the leave request is for **more than 2 days**, employees should still give their team lead a heads-up **in person or via call** before submitting on Keep Kaam.

Casual leaves

- All permanent team members are eligible for casual leaves.
- The team member shall first notify his/her team lead of his/her request to avail casual leave in person.
- The request must then be formally submitted **through Keep Kaam**, which routes it to the team lead for approval and **notifies HR automatically** once approved.
- This leave can be consecutively taken for **no more than 2 days**.
- Planned leaves will be considered as casual leaves.

Sick leaves

- All team members are eligible for sick leave.
- The team member shall notify his/her team lead of his/her medical condition for sick leave.
- The sick leave must be formally recorded by submitting it **through Keep Kaam**, which routes it to the team lead for approval and **notifies HR automatically**.

- For sick leave of more than 2 days, the HR department might ask for a medical certificate from a medical practitioner on a case to case basis.

Annual leaves

- After completion of **12 months** of continuous service you are eligible to avail Annual leaves.
- Annual leaves are paid leaves.
- Team members are entitled to a maximum of **15 calendar days** (inclusive of weekends and public holidays) as annuals.
- More than **2 consecutive leaves** will be considered as Annual leaves.
- Team members cannot take more than **5 leaves** consecutively.
- **Annual leave requests must be submitted through Keep Kaam** at least 30 days in advance. The request is routed to the team lead for approval, and once approved, **HR is notified automatically** and the leave balance updates on the employee's dashboard.

Example: Imagine there's a person named Person A. They have 15 annual leave days that he can use for taking time off from work.

Scenario 1:

- Person A applied for annual leave from July 10 (Monday) to July 14 (Friday)
- However, their last working day before taking leave was July 07 (Friday)

This means that Person A used 5 annual leave days starting from Monday (July 10) and ending on Friday (July 14).

Scenario 2:

After taking leave from July 10 (Monday) to July 14 (Friday), let's say Person A decides to take off again on the coming Monday, which is July 17. In this case, not only will Monday (July 17) be counted as an annual leave day, but also the two days before, Saturday (July 15) and Sunday (July 16). So, in total, for this second leave, Person A used 3 days: July 15, July 16, and July 17.

Considering both scenarios together, Person A initially used 5 annual leave days. In the second scenario, they used 3 more annual leave days. This adds up to a total of 8 annual leave days consumed.

In summary, the person initially took 5 days off, and in the second scenario, they took 3 more days off, making it a total of 8 days of annual leave used.

- Team members can take annuals more than one time in a year.
- **Annual leave requests, including the team lead's approval, are handled entirely within Keep Kaam** and must be submitted at least **30 days in advance**.

- Annual Leaves cannot be en-cashed any time during service or at the time of final settlement.

Leave Approval Guidelines

Please be mindful of the following guidelines when approving your team member's annual leaves:

- Ensure that the team member has completed 1 year of service with the company in case of Annual Leaves. You can consult HR if you are not sure of the tenure of the team member yourself.
- If a team member has worked in multiple projects in a year, the current team lead should take into account the track record of the previous leaves taken along with the existing leave quota.
- All team leads and leave approvers should go through leave approval guidelines before approving annual leaves.
- Take consent from the client if needed.
- Make sure that there are no tasks affected in the team member's absence and there is someone to back his/her work. If there isn't anyone available from within your team as a backup, you can consult HR beforehand.
- Maintain fairness among team members when approving annual leaves.

Leave during Probation

- Employees on probation are entitled to two (2) paid sick leaves during their probation period.
- These leaves are not cashable, accumulated or carried forward to the term afterwards.

Leaves in Notice Period

- No leaves are allowed in the Notice Period.
- Team members will face salary deduction for taking off days.

Unpaid leaves

- In cases where a team member is not entitled to annuals but needs to take off, they can take approval for unpaid leaves.
- Team members can also apply for unpaid leaves when the leave application exceeds the duration a team lead is willing to approve.
- These requests are also submitted **through Keep Kaam**, keeping approval and HR notification consistent across every leave type.

Leaves for Contractual/Part-time Team members:

- You are entitled to avail 6 sick leaves.
- You can utilize one leave per month.
- In case if you will not use that month's leave then it will not be carried forward to the other month and hence one leave will be reduced from your quota.

Wedding leaves

- All permanent team members of Cogent Labs are eligible for it.
- All permanent team members of Cogent Labs are entitled to avail paid leaves for their own marriage subject to a maximum of 1 week (Including 5 working days).
- Any additional leave in this regard shall be considered as unpaid or can be adjusted against Annual Leave upon the availability of balance.

Additional Notes

- Leaves of any type will not be carried forward.
- Team Lead should be informed in advance when taking sick/casual leave, and the request should be submitted **through Keep Kaam** so HR is notified automatically, no separate email is needed.
- All leave calculations will be done from January to December. Leaves will be renewed on a yearly basis starting from January 1.
- An employee may accumulate its annual leaves with long leave, in case of Hajj, Umrah or Wedding.
- For team leads and team members working alone with the client, annual leaves would be approved by HR.
- For team members who are working in a team but do not have a team lead, HR will appoint someone as their “leave approver” from within their team.

Leave Types

<i>Leave Types</i>	<i>Internship</i>	<i>Probation</i>	<i>Permanent and Confirmed</i>	<i>After 1 year</i>	<i>Informing Time</i>
Casual Leaves	N/A	N/A	Upon team lead's approval	Upon team lead's approval	A day prior
Sick Leaves	2	2	Upon team lead's approval	Upon team lead's approval	Ideally a day prior

<i>Leave Types</i>	<i>Internship</i>	<i>Probation</i>	<i>Permanent and Confirmed</i>	<i>After 1 year</i>	<i>Informing Time</i>
Emergency Leave			Upon team lead's approval	Upon team lead's approval	Ideally before working hours
Annual Leaves	N/A	N/A	N/A	Upon team lead and HR's approval	30 days prior
Wedding Leaves	N/A	N/A	Eligible	Upon team lead and HR's approval	30 days prior

Sandwich Rule Application

Sandwich Rule:

The sandwich rule will be applied to all types of leaves if they fall before and after announced holidays, weekends, or public holidays. This means that if a leave request includes days both before and after a holiday or weekend, then the intervening holiday(s) or weekend(s) will also be counted as leave days.

For example:

If a team member takes leave on a Friday and the following Monday, then the weekend (Saturday and Sunday) will also be considered part of the leave.

Please be mindful of this rule when planning your leaves, and ensure to consult with your team lead before finalizing your leave application.

To explore further scenarios & edge cases regarding sandwich policy, kindly review the following [document](#)